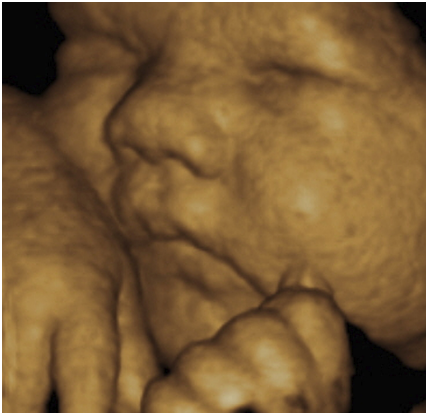




YOU ARE **38 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

12 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Your baby's head, deep within your pelvis, remains rounded in shape. It is not until labor starts that the bones of the skull move closer to each other, elongating the shape of the head, and allowing your baby to pass more easily along the birth canal.

“ Although your baby will be born with beautifully big eyes, it will be some time before they will see clearly at a distance. ”

Your baby's eyes are almost their adult size at birth. Although the eyes continue to grow very slightly until adolescence, and the lens within the eye grows throughout life, the eye is three-quarters of its adult size at birth. Both color (cones) and black and white visual cells (rods) are present in the retina, but vision is still rather poor — equivalent to being able to just see the top letter of the optician's chart. This is referred to as 20/400 vision. This means that if the baby could read, then they could read a letter at 20 ft (6 m) that a person with perfect vision could read when 400 ft (122 m) away. Because of this, your newborn may not seem to pay much attention at first; they'll have some difficulty focusing and their eye muscles will be quite weak. They will, however, be able to see objects 12 in (30 cm) away (roughly the distance between your breast and face), so they can see your face as they feed. They'll be six to eight weeks old before fixing onto and following an object, four months before they can judge distances, and two years of age before their vision has perfected to 20/20.